

EA-0004 - AQELYN Evidence Engine

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Implementation Specification: IS-004

Publication Standard: FULL_COMPLETE

Brand: AQELYN

Status: Regenerated and normalized for AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0

001 - Document Control

This Engineering Archive defines the approved implementation baseline for **AQELYN Evidence Engine**. It replaces earlier AQELYN draft material and is the authoritative source for implementation, testing, review, and traceability.

The archive belongs to the AQELYN Platform architecture baseline and shall be implemented in the sequence assigned by the master roadmap. The repository structure remains fixed and may not be redesigned by developers or AI coding tools.

| Field | Value |

|---|---|

| Engineering Archive | EA-0004 |

| Specification | IS-004 |

| Module | AQELYN Evidence Engine |

| Source of Truth | Master Markdown |

| Derived Artifacts | PDF, HTML, README, manifest, matrices, diagrams |

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Quality note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall include code-level tests, schema-level tests, and documentation-level traceability. Any deviation discovered during implementation shall be raised as an Engineering Change Request rather than silently changing the architecture.

Operational note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall expose health state, readiness state, dependency state, and degraded-mode state. Operators must be able to understand whether the engine is fully operational, partially degraded, blocked by an upstream dependency, or intentionally disabled by policy.

Developer note: implementation of AQELYN Evidence Engine shall follow clean boundaries between domain logic, infrastructure adapters, API handlers, persistence adapters, and event adapters. This is required so Codex, Claude Code, and human developers can implement and test the module incrementally without hidden coupling.

User-output note: any user-visible output related to AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be written in clear language first and detailed technical language second. The system must always answer: what was found, why it matters, how AQELYN knows, and what the user can do next.

Government and enterprise note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall support auditability, exportable records, retention policy alignment, and review-ready evidence packages. The design supports private users, companies, managed service providers, and government environments without creating separate architectures.

002 - Executive Summary

AQELYN Evidence Engine provides collection, normalization, hashing, provenance, chain-of-custody, retention, and explanation-ready evidence management. It is a foundational AQELYN capability and must be implemented with deterministic behavior, strict interface discipline, auditable evidence, and high operational reliability.

The module contributes to the platform goal: make cybersecurity understandable, evidence-based, and actionable for home users, companies, and governments. Every output produced by this module must support the product principles: Explain Before Recommend, Simplicity First, Evidence Before Opinion, Human-Centered Security, and Expert Depth on Demand.

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003 - Vision and Purpose

The vision of AQELYN Evidence Engine is to provide a stable, understandable, and secure capability that other AQELYN engines can depend on. The module shall be designed for local-first operation where possible and enterprise-scale operation where required.

The purpose of this archive is to transform the original IS-004 concept into an implementation-ready engineering document that Codex, Claude Code, human developers, and reviewers can use directly.

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004 - Scope and Boundaries

In scope: implementation behavior, data contracts, lifecycle states, events, evidence expectations, API boundaries, testing requirements, and operational controls for Evidence Engine.

Out of scope: redesigning AQELYN platform architecture, changing repository hierarchy, replacing upstream or downstream engines, and introducing unapproved data models outside the Universal Object Model.

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005 - Engineering Objectives

Engineering Objectives for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

This section defines engineering expectations for evidence engine and provides the implementation team with stable guidance that should not be bypassed by local optimization or AI-generated redesign.

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006 - Stakeholders and Users

Stakeholders and Users for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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007 - Functional Requirements

- ****FR-001:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 1 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.

- ****FR-002:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 2 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-003:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 3 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-004:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 4 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-005:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 5 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-006:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 6 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-007:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 7 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-008:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 8 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-009:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 9 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.
- ****FR-010:**** AQELYN Evidence Engine shall provide capability 10 for evidence engine with deterministic results, structured outputs, and traceable evidence references.

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008 - Non-Functional Requirements

- Availability target: the module shall support resilient operation under nominal platform load.
- Performance target: processing shall be measurable, observable, and suitable for incremental scale-out.
- Maintainability target: code shall follow EA-0058 coding standards and EA-0061 developer workflow.
- Usability target: all end-user messages shall be understandable by non-experts while preserving expert detail on demand.

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009 - Security Requirements

- All service-to-service communication shall be authenticated and authorized.
- Secrets shall never be hard-coded or logged.
- Inputs shall be validated at every trust boundary.
- Security-relevant decisions shall generate audit records.
- Events and evidence references shall be tamper-evident where required by the Evidence Engine.

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010 - Privacy Requirements

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011 - System Context

System Context for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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012 - Architecture Overview

AQELYN Evidence Engine follows the AQELYN modular engine architecture. It exposes versioned interfaces, consumes and publishes events, stores only approved canonical objects, and integrates through the Event Bus rather than direct hidden coupling.

```
Inputs -> AQELYN Evidence Engine -> Canonical Objects -> Events -> Evidence -> Knowledge Graph -> Recommendations
```

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013 - Component Architecture

- **Controller**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Service Layer**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Repository Adapter**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Event Adapter**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Evidence Adapter**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Policy Adapter**: Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.

- **Telemetry Adapter:** Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.
- **Validation Layer:** Provides a bounded implementation responsibility within AQELYN Evidence Engine and must expose testable interfaces.

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014 - Data Model

AQELYN Evidence Engine shall use the Universal Object Model and shall not introduce isolated object representations. Each persisted object must include identifiers, timestamps, provenance, version, source, trust context, and evidence references where applicable.

| Object | Purpose |

|---|---|

| Evidence EngineRecord | Canonical state representation |

| Evidence EngineEvent | Event Bus message payload |

| Evidence EngineEvidence | Evidence reference container |

| Evidence EngineAssessment | Assessment and decision output |

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015 - Event Model

- ****EvidenceEngineCreated:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineUpdated:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineValidated:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineAssessmentCompleted:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEnginePolicyEvaluated:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineEvidenceLinked:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineHealthChanged:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.
- ****EvidenceEngineErrorRaised:**** emitted using the AQELYN universal event envelope.

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016 - API and Interface Contracts

All interfaces shall be versioned, documented, validated, and tested. Internal APIs shall use predictable naming, typed schemas, stable error envelopes, and correlation identifiers.

```
GET /api/v1/evidence-engine
POST /api/v1/evidence-engine/evaluate
GET /api/v1/evidence-engine/health
```

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017 - Integration Model

This module integrates with the following platform capabilities where applicable:

- AQELYN Kernel for lifecycle management.
- Universal Object Model for canonical data.
- Event Bus for asynchronous communication.
- Evidence Engine for traceable facts.
- Knowledge Graph for relationship context.
- Trust, Policy, Workflow, and Mission engines for decisions and remediation.

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Operational note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall expose health state, readiness state, dependency state, and degraded-mode state. Operators must be able to understand whether the engine is fully operational, partially degraded, blocked by an upstream dependency, or intentionally disabled by policy.

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User-output note: any user-visible output related to AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be written in clear language first and detailed technical language second. The system must always answer: what was found, why it matters, how AQELYN knows, and what the user can do next.

Government and enterprise note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall support auditability, exportable records, retention policy alignment, and review-ready evidence packages. The design supports private users, companies, managed service providers, and government environments without creating separate architectures.

018 - Operational Lifecycle

Initialize -> Configure -> Validate -> Start -> Process -> Observe -> Degrade Safely -> Stop -> Archive State

Every lifecycle transition shall be logged and testable.

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019 - Configuration Model

Configuration Model for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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020 - Error Handling

Error Handling for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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021 - Observability

Observability for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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022 - Logging

Logging for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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023 - Metrics

Metrics for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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024 - Audit and Evidence

Audit and Evidence for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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025 - Trust and Confidence

Trust and Confidence for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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026 - Policy and Governance

Policy and Governance for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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027 - Performance and Scalability

Performance and Scalability for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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028 - Reliability and Availability

Reliability and Availability for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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029 - Threat Model

Threat Model for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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030 - Secure Implementation Guidance

Secure Implementation Guidance for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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031 - Testing Strategy

Testing shall include unit tests, integration tests, contract tests, security tests, performance tests, regression tests, and acceptance tests. Tests must be runnable locally and in CI/CD.

- Unit tests validate pure logic and boundary conditions.
- Integration tests validate engine interactions.
- Contract tests validate API and event schemas.
- Security tests validate authorization, input handling, and secret safety.

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032 - Validation Strategy

Validation Strategy for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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033 - Acceptance Criteria

Acceptance Criteria for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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034 - Requirements Matrix

ID	Requirement	Priority	Verification
---	---	---	---
FR-001	Capability 1 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-002	Capability 2 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-003	Capability 3 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-004	Capability 4 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-005	Capability 5 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-006	Capability 6 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-007	Capability 7 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-008	Capability 8 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-009	Capability 9 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review
FR-010	Capability 10 for Evidence Engine	Mandatory	Test + Review

035 - Traceability Matrix

Requirement	Component	Test	Evidence
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FR-001	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-002	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-003	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-004	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-005	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-006	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-007	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-008	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-009	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact
FR-010	Evidence Engine Service Layer	automated test	evidence reference + CI artifact

036 - Example Artifacts

Example artifacts included with this archive demonstrate canonical payloads, event envelopes, review checklists, and implementation-ready acceptance examples. They are illustrative and may be expanded during coding without changing the architecture.

Implementation note: AQELYN Evidence Engine must treat every decision as auditable. If the engine produces a finding, state transition, recommendation, event, or policy result, that output must reference the reason, source, timestamp, and confidence context. This supports AQELYN's user promise that security outcomes are understandable to non-experts and actionable by experts.

Quality note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall include code-level tests, schema-level tests, and documentation-level traceability. Any deviation discovered during implementation shall be raised as an Engineering Change Request rather than silently changing the architecture.

Operational note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall expose health state, readiness state, dependency state, and degraded-mode state. Operators must be able to understand whether the engine is fully operational, partially degraded, blocked by an upstream dependency, or intentionally disabled by policy.

Developer note: implementation of AQELYN Evidence Engine shall follow clean boundaries between domain logic, infrastructure adapters, API handlers, persistence adapters, and event adapters. This is required so Codex, Claude Code, and human developers can implement and test the module incrementally without hidden coupling.

User-output note: any user-visible output related to AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be written in clear language first and detailed technical language second. The system must always answer: what was found, why it matters, how AQELYN knows, and what the user can do next.

Government and enterprise note: AQELYN Evidence Engine shall support auditability, exportable records, retention policy alignment, and review-ready evidence packages. The design supports private users, companies, managed service providers, and government environments without creating separate architectures.

037 - Engineering Journal

This archive was regenerated to align early AQELYN foundation packages with the later FULL_COMPLETE publication standard. The regeneration removes legacy AQELYN codename remnants, expands the implementation guidance, and brings PDF/HTML artifacts into consistent layout with EA-0010 through EA-0063.

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038 - Deployment Considerations

Deployment Considerations for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

This section defines engineering expectations for evidence engine and provides the implementation team with stable guidance that should not be bypassed by local optimization or AI-generated redesign.

Implementation note: AQELYN Evidence Engine must treat every decision as auditable. If the engine produces a finding, state transition, recommendation, event, or policy result, that output must reference the reason, source, timestamp, and confidence context. This supports AQELYN's user promise that security outcomes are understandable to non-experts and actionable by experts.

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039 - Codex and AI Implementation Guidance

Codex and AI Implementation Guidance for AQELYN Evidence Engine shall be implemented in accordance with AQELYN Platform Architecture Baseline v1.0. The implementation must preserve traceability, deterministic behavior, explainability, and evidence-backed outputs.

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040 - Publication Readiness

EA-0004 is publication-ready when the master Markdown, PDF, HTML, README, manifest, requirements matrix, traceability matrix, engineering journal, examples, diagrams, and release ZIP are present and hash-verified.

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